

V15 Virtual Interview and Digital Portfolio Design

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate advanced proficiency in job search strategies, portfolio development, and interview skills within a virtual environment. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary, or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Contestants who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register members for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2027 National Virtual Events”
 - There will be a \$10 fee for each entry (*invoiced during event registration*)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit all of the following in one combined PDF: 1. Clickable URL to Digital Portfolio 2. Resume 3. Cover Letter 4. Works Cited 5. BPA Release Form(s) 6. AI Usage and Documentation Form	V15-ContestantID.pdf	January 15, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Apply technical writing skills to produce a professional cover letter, resume, and digital portfolio tailored to a targeted job opportunity
2. Conduct job market research to identify position qualifications, required skills, and industry expectations, and align application materials accordingly
3. Demonstrate knowledge of employability skills and job advancement strategies, including the professional behaviors and competencies required to obtain, retain, and grow within a career
4. Project a professional image through appearance, demeanor, and conduct that reflects workplace standards and expectations in a virtual environment
5. Demonstrate effective communication and interpersonal skills, and apply knowledge of workplace ethics and professional environment expectations to interact appropriately in a business setting

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Contestant will indicate on his/her resume the position for which he/she is applying. There are openings in all departments of Digital Solutions shown on the Organizational Chart found in the *Style & Reference Manual*. Contestant may interview for any position listed on the organizational chart for which he/she is qualified.

- Information in the cover letter and résumé must be authentic; however, contestants may choose to use a fictitious personal address and telephone number. The use of references on the resume is optional.
- The cover letter must be addressed as follows:
Ms. Julie Smith, Manager
Human Resources Department
Digital Solutions
1365 King Avenue
Columbus, OH 43212
- Contestant must create a digital portfolio. Digital portfolios can be a website, interactive file, or other digital solution.
 - Online digital portfolios must be live and working between January 15 – March 1 for judging purposes. Those that are submitted but not online may result in a disqualification
- Submit the URL to the digital portfolio, resume, cover letter, Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on January 15, 2027. No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.
- Advisors of qualifying contestants will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Contestant will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- The top contestants with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Contestant ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The contestant is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.



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Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
The following items have been submitted in one combined (1) PDF. 1. Digital Portfolio 2. Cover Letter 3. Resume 4. Works Cited 5. BPA Release Form(s) 6. AI Usage and Documentation Form				/10
Cover Letter	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Introduction	Introduction is unclear or not properly addressed.	Introduction is clear and appropriately addressed.	Introduction is engaging and tailored to the position and audience.	/20
Skills	Skills mentioned are vague or not relevant to the position.	Skills are relevant and clearly connected to the position.	Skills are well-articulated and strongly aligned with the role.	/20
Closing	Closing is abrupt or lacks professionalism.	Closing is polite and professionally written.	Closing is confident, polished, and leaves a strong impression.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent errors in grammar, spelling, or punctuation.	Writing is mostly error-free and professionally structured.	Writing is polished, precise, and enhances clarity and professionalism.	/20
Resume	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Position Listed	Position is missing or unclear.	Position is clearly stated and relevant.	Position is clearly stated and strategically aligned with resume content.	/20
Layout	Layout is cluttered or difficult to follow.	Layout is clean and easy to read.	Layout is professional, visually appealing, and enhances readability.	/20
Work History Order	Work history is incomplete or not in reverse chronological order.	Work history is complete and in reverse chronological.	Work history is thorough, well-organized, and highlights relevant experience and is in reverse chronological.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent errors in grammar, spelling, or punctuation.	Writing is mostly error-free and professionally structured.	Writing is polished, precise, and enhances clarity and professionalism.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric Cont'd

Digital Portfolio	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Evidence of Work	Work samples are missing or do not reflect relevant skills.	Includes relevant work samples that demonstrate applicable skills.	Work samples are diverse, high-quality, and strongly showcase relevant skills.	/20
Certificates & Credentials	Relevant credentials are missing or unclear.	Includes appropriate certificates and credentials.	Credentials are well-selected, clearly presented, and enhance qualifications.	/20
Layout & Design	Portfolio is cluttered or visually inconsistent.	Portfolio is clean, organized, and visually consistent.	Portfolio is professionally designed, visually engaging, and easy to navigate.	/20
Personal/Professional Statement	Statement is missing or unrelated to the position.	Statement is included and aligns with the position.	Statement is compelling, well-written, and clearly tailored to the position.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/250

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Applicant's Greeting	Introduction is unclear or lacks professionalism.	Properly introduces self and makes a positive first impression.	Introduction is confident, polished, and immediately engaging.	/20
Applicant's Appearance	Appearance is unprofessional or inappropriate.	Neat, well-groomed, and dressed appropriately.	Appearance is highly professional and enhances overall presentation.	/20
Personality and Poise	Appears nervous or disengaged; poor posture or eye contact.	Courteous, confident, and maintains good posture and eye contact.	Displays strong presence, sincerity, and poise throughout.	/20
Communication Skills	Poor grammar, unclear speech, or distracting tone.	Speaks clearly with proper grammar and pleasant tone.	Communicates with clarity, warmth, and excellent verbal skills.	/20
Responses	Responses are vague or show limited understanding.	Answers are appropriate and show knowledge of the position and company.	Responses are thoughtful, informed, and demonstrate enthusiasm and initiative.	/20
Job Skills Evidence	Shows little evidence of relevant skills or habits.	Demonstrates required job skills and good work habits.	Clearly showcases strong skills, problem-solving abilities, and professionalism.	/20
Close of Interview	Fails to thank or conclude effectively.	Expresses thanks and ends the interview appropriately.	Concludes with confidence, professionalism, and a lasting positive impression.	/20
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/140

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.